SAMPLE

The Seasoned Veteran

The Personality of Breadth That Masters Every Tool

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Chapter 1: The First Glance — the Seasoned Veteran at a Party

The Telltale Manner

The party tell is the conversation that keeps changing trades — and the field manual's first finding is how completely it inverts the room's math: the host mentions the remodeled kitchen and the Veteran has a story about load-bearing walls, from the year the Veteran remodeled one; the doctor at the table mentions her residency and the Veteran asks a question about call schedules that only someone who has worked one would ask; the musician mentions the tour and the Veteran has the promoter's grammar down cold; the farmer, the lawyer, the welder, the teacher — each, within the hour, professionally met — the room's two responses, both accurate: astonished (this person has apparently done everything, and every answer arrives with a working detail, a war story, an instructive scar — the breadth is not bluffing; the drawer is real) and unsettled, in exactly one observer per party — the one who eventually asks the question the whole file exists to take seriously: "wait — what do you actually do?" — and the Veteran's answer, warm, calm, and delivered with the same faint amusement, is the type's signature and its whole architecture in one sentence: "oh — a bit of everything, honestly. I did that for a while, actually." And the small tell that separates the genuine one from the ordinary name-dropper: the drawer of answers — ask the Veteran anything and there is a pause, one beat long, while the hand goes to the drawer; the answer, when it comes, is practiced — the working knowledge of a person who has done the thing, not read about it: the feel of the tool, the smell of the room, the mistake everyone makes in their first month — and the field manual's diagnostic note: the Veteran never says "I know about that." The Veteran says, quietly, at some point, I was that.

The Backstory Signature

The signature in the past is the many begun things — and the first posting, assembled across a hundred case files, is always a variation on one architecture: curiosity as survival. The house had a collapse in it — the father's single trade that failed him (the factory that closed, the shop that died, the profession that the times retired); the mother's single identity that was a single point of failure (the one role, the one devotion, the one gamble — and when it broke, the whole person broke with it) — and the child, watching the adult who had only been one thing come apart with the one thing, did the arithmetic that no child should have to do: one specialty is one hiding place, and a hiding place is somewhere the world can find you. And the vow, never spoken but kept absolutely: never be only one thing — the self began collecting, and the collecting had two engines braided in it: the wonder, real and enormous (the child who genuinely wanted to know how everything worked — the engine, the recipe, the

map, the code, the contract, the choir); and the armor, quiet and structural (the child who noticed, without words, that the adults who fell were the ones who could be found where they stood) — and the two engines fused in the first posting's discovery: understanding everything means nothing can corner you — and the childhood became the first drawer: the clarinet year, the telescope year, the model-bridge year, the bakery counter, the neighbor's garage, each entered at a run, mastered to working depth — good enough to function, good enough to be trusted with the task — and left, always, at the plateau, with the next tool already shining. And the field manual's founding finding, entered with care: the child never experienced the leaving as quitting. The plateau's boredom was honest — the tool was working; the learning was done; the fascination's fuel was spent — and the next tool's shine was equally honest. The armor, the field manual notes, was invisible inside a genuine gift: a wonder as wide as any in this catalog, with a vow for a spine.

The Childhood Album

Open the deployment album and the photos are a different hobby every year: the clarinet portrait of the fourth grade, the loadout already half-abandoned by the photograph's date; the telescope on the lawn, the summer of the comet, the eyepiece never touched again by autumn; the model-bridge ribbon from the school science fair — a ribbon, the field manual notes, third place, working depth achieved and left; the bakery apron, the neighbor's garage, the bicycle-repair shop of the ninth year, photographed by a bemused parent who had stopped predicting interests and started just documenting them — and the field manual's first observation: this is the most documented breadth in this catalog, and the documentation is the parents' honest bewilderment, loving and uncomprehending: "we never knew what to get them for their birthday, because whatever we got was what they were into for three months" — the deployment album is a series of three-month fascinations, each one real, each one worked to the point of function, each one replaced. And the deployment album's most telling feature is the recurring corner object: the half-finished project — in the background of six photographs across four years, the same shelf: the kit two-thirds built, the engine half-restored, the novel at chapter nine — and the field manual's careful margin note: the child's finishes were functional, not final — the bridge held its ribbon and was never sanded; the clarinet made the recital and was never mastered — the working depth, the deployment album's whole grammar, achieved and departed, at the exact altitude where the specialist's childhood would have begun. And the recurring figure is the collapsing adult — in the deployment album's oldest photographs, the father or the mother of the first posting, mid-collapse: the single-trade parent in the single-identity photograph, the shop's closing day, the professional's last convention — and the child, in the corner of those frames, watching — the deployment album documents a childhood that was, in the field manual's plainest finding, raised on the proof of the first posting's vow: the one-thing adult fell when the one thing fell — and the many-thing child decided, quietly, in the corner of those photographs, never to be findable at all.

The Type at a Glance

Energy: Curiosity-fed — the type runs brightest on the new tool's slope: the first months of any craft, the steep part of the learning curve, where wonder and armor are both fully engaged — and the field manual's quiet finding: the energy does not fade at difficulty (the Veteran is not lazy; the steep part is the work); it fades at competence — the plateau, the last 20 percent of mastery where the learning curve flattens into repetition — and the type's whole biography is a sequence of slopes climbed brilliantly and plateaus exited cleanly, with the fuel for the last mile somehow never once on the truck.

Ambition: Option-shaped — the goals on file are capacities, not summits: "be able to handle anything," "never be caught without an answer," "be the one they call" — and the field manual's blunt finding: the type has never once held an ambition of the form be the best in the world at, because best-in-the-world is a place, and places can be found; the Veteran's ambitions are all grids — coverage, not altitude — and the service log shows the pattern's cost honestly: thirty years of ambitions achieved, every single one, and the type at sixty still asking the question the drawer cannot answer: what do I want to be when I grow up?

Vanity structure: The drawer — the quiet, total pride in the working breadth: the story that opens any room, the tool for any Tuesday, the calm of the person who has an answer for everything; and beneath it the first posting's arithmetic: only the many-thing self is safe — which is also the trap, because the vanity prices the summit at zero, and quietly at negative: the type's one audible judgment, deployed against the specialists of the world with a warmth that does not hide the edge: "I could never do just one thing" — a sentence the field manual has heard in a hundred interviews, and the sentence's undertow, held for the seasoning chapter, is the shadow's whole subject: it is envy, misfiled as temperament.

Loyalty: Paid to the crafts, not the institutions — the Veteran's loyalty runs to tools and trades: the wood, the code, the kitchen, the language — each craft held in warm regard forever, revisited, contributed to, defended; and the field manual notes the specific shape: this is the only type in this catalog whose loyalty has no address — the institutions were stops, the colleagues were seasons, the companies were clients of the drawer — and the type's real community, discovered late, is the network of everyone the breadth has served: the list of people who call, decades long, when something breaks, which is, the field manual notes, a genuine and magnificent inheritance, and the only one the pattern ever compounds.

Weakness: The departure reflex — this type cannot stay on a plateau: the last fifth of any mastery, the repetition-years where craft becomes depth, fires the engine's oldest alarm — the learning is done; the next tool is shining; staying is stagnation — and the blindness riding with it: the Veteran does not know the plateau is where mastery lives; the type has filed the repetition-years under "boredom," and the field manual will spend this whole book correcting the filing: the plateau is not the end of the growth curve. The plateau is the growth curve — the slow compounding of the working depth

into the deep — and it is the one terrain the armor refuses to walk, because the plateau is, in the first posting's arithmetic, exactly where the world found the father.

Unspoken need: To find out whether one thing held long enough becomes home — whether depth is a kind of belonging; and beneath that, the need the vow makes unspeakable: to be caught, once, standing still — to discover that the self that stops collecting is not the self that falls (the father's fate) but the self that finally arrives: the one craft that gets the last fifth, the one summit with the Veteran's name on it, the one place the world can find the self and the self, at last, wants to be found — because the whole drawer, the field manual enters at the glance's close, was built by a child who believed that being found meant falling, and the whole growth chapter is the discovery, made at the top of one mountain, that the found self is the only one that gets to see the view.

The Type in Five Situations

At a party: the conversation that changes trades, the drawer of answers, the working detail in every reply — the room's most useful guest and its least placeable one; the guests' private verdict, never said aloud: "they can do everything. What do they do? It's the only question they can't answer, and I've noticed they laugh every time I ask it."

In a new job: the utility player — the hire who is competent at three desks in month one, the fixer who has already read the whole org's functions out of curiosity; and the institution's honest discovery, made early: this one can go anywhere — and the field manual's cold note on the discovery's fine print: the institution gets a magnificently flexible instrument and never gets a master of anything it does — the Veteran fills gaps, covers crises, bridges departments — and the career that follows is the service log's most useful and least ranked: twenty years of indispensable coverage, no specialty's title, the last promotion always going to someone who stayed on one plateau.

Under sudden pressure: superb — and the field manual must enter this honestly, because it is the drawer's finest hour: the crisis hits and the right tool is already in the drawer — the flood met with the plumbing year, the layoff met with the books, the collapse met with the one person who has done everyone's job and knows where all the bodies are; the calm of the breadth in a crisis is the catalog's steadiest, and the vulnerability, entered with care: the improvised fix is the pattern's proof — the Veteran saves the day without becoming the day's specialist, hands it off at the plateau of resolution, and moves on, and the field manual's cold note: the crisis is the breadth's greatest reward and its cleverest bribe — every emergency confirms the drawer, and no emergency ever once asks the type to climb.

In a boring meeting: the adjacent tool — the agenda item on the thing the Veteran worked at for a while, surfacing the drawer mid-meeting: the one person in the room with hands-on memory of the problem, quietly contributing the working detail nobody else has — and the meeting's quiet anomaly, noticed by exactly one observant

colleague per case file: the most broadly experienced person in the room never stays for the career the detail would have led to — and the colleague's private verdict, never said aloud: "they've forgotten more jobs than I'll ever have. I once asked them which of them they wanted to keep. They laughed. Same laugh as when they say they could never do just one thing. I've started keeping a list of what makes them laugh."

On holiday: the shop tour — the family gathering where the Veteran is, for once, fully fed: every relative's project heard, every hobbyist's craft entered from experience, the cousin's guitar re-strung by the year of the luthier's bench, the aunt's recipe corrected by the bakery year — the household's most beloved guest and its least settled one; and the family's oldest misreading, entered at the first posting and never corrected: "they're so knowledgeable about everything" — true, and the misreading: the knowledge is filed by the family as riches, when the field manual's finding, held across every biography in this volume, is the shadow's whole sentence: the Veteran goes home from the holidays fed by everyone's craft except their own — because there is no their own — and the garage, back home, holds the deployment album's grammar at sixty: the shelf of half-finished projects, working depth achieved, the next tool, always, shining.

Not to Be Confused With

Not the Untamed Wanderer, the personality who roams for the self's own joy — the confusion is instant, because both biographies read, from the outside, as collector's lives: many places, many trades, many stories, one open road of a resume. The hinge is the currency of the collection. The Wanderer collects geography — the self moves through space, and the breadth is horizontal: the places are the point, the leaving is appetite, the horizon is the food. The Veteran collects capability — the self stays put in space and moves through skill, and the breadth is vertical in trades: the tools are the point, the leaving is the plateau reflex, the learning curve is the food. Watch both at the same party: the Wanderer's stories all begin where ("so I was in this port town in Chile..."); the Veteran's stories all begin what ("so I was running this kitchen for a winter...") — and the field manual's line on the pair: one is many places, one self; the other is one place, many trades, one self — and the two can each give the other the mirror's gift: the Wanderer shows the Veteran what leaving looks like when nothing is being armored against; the Veteran shows the Wanderer what depth does to a craft when the leaving stops — but watch them both stay, put side by side at the same table for a year: the Wanderer pines for the road and the Veteran pines for the foothills — and the pining is the pair's whole lesson: neither one has ever once been homesick for a mountain, and both of them, the field manual enters with care, have one.

Not the Tireless Workhorse, the personality whose engine is motion as obligation — the confusion is subtler, because both types are many-thing lives, busy hands, long days, a lifetime of tasks completed under other people's roofs. The hinge is the author of the many. The Workhorse's many tasks are assigned — the engine is other people's logistics, the motion is obligation, and the many-thing life is a list written by others; the field manual has shown that type's restlessness is the house's demands. The

Veteran's many tasks are chosen — the engine is the drawer, the motion is curiosity, and the many-thing life is a list written by the self, in wonder, with a vow for a spine. Watch both at the same job site: the Workhorse is carrying the load someone else priced; the Veteran is carrying the load that taught them something — and the pair's tell, quick and diagnostic: the Workhorse cannot say no; the Veteran cannot say stay. Ask both to keep one specialty for a decade: the Workhorse stays out of duty and quietly starves; the Veteran stays out of duty never — and leaves within the year, warmly, with the working depth achieved and the next tool shining, and the field manual's line on the pair: one is owned by the many; the other is saved by it — and the difference, invisible from the outside, is the whole catalog's worth of interior weather, and the seasoning chapter's, in both volumes, identical in shape: the Workhorse's is learning to rest; the Veteran's is learning to stay.

Chapter 2: The Core — the Engine of the Drawer

Every archetype on this shelf runs on a childhood fix that worked, and the Seasoned Veteran's is the only one that looks like an armory — a survival problem solved not by raising one fortress (the Matriarch), a single uniform (the Ace), or one exit (the Guide), but by stocking every tool the world might ever demand — and the solution worked so completely that the stocking never stopped. The first posting, assembled from a hundred case files: the collapse in the house — the one-trade parent, the one-identity fall — and the child who did the arithmetic (one specialty is one hiding place) and took the vow (never be only one thing), with two engines braided in it: the wonder, real and enormous, and the armor, quiet and structural. And the first posting's discovery, made at every fascin's slope and kept for life: the parts of a craft worth having are the first four-fifths — the working depth, the function, the fluency — and the last fifth, the plateau, the mastery, is where the world finds you standing still. So the engine installed itself: breadth as identity — every tool learned to working depth, the type's competence measured in options rather than summits. And the wage: a double stroke the field manual is required to mark precisely, since the story of the adult years cannot be decoded while the mechanism stays unnamed.

The first stroke is the coverage — and the field manual enters it first, plainly, because it is the first posting's true gift and the type's public identity: the drawer delivers. Every crisis, every gap, every strange Tuesday — the tool is in the drawer, warm, oiled, working: the Veteran is the most useful person in every room they enter, and the world, from the first neighbor's garage to the last board's crisis, has paid the drawer daily, in the exact currency the first posting made precious: safety — and the field manual's honest entry: the safety is real. Nothing has ever cornered this self. Layoffs, collapses, disruptions, the industry's tides — the Veteran has watched them all come and go, and walked through them, retooling at the slope of whatever the new world demanded, and this book will never once ask the type to regret the drawer, because the drawer genuinely saved the life the first posting watched fall.

The second stroke is the economy's hidden ledger — and this is the first posting's subtlest bequest, the clause that keeps the engine running for life: the plateau is

priced as danger. Every craft's last fifth — the repetition-years, the compounding depth, the mastery — is experienced, in the armor's arithmetic, as standing still, and standing still is where the world found the father; so the departure reflex, firing at every plateau, is not boredom and not fickleness: it is navigation away from the first posting's single image of doom — and the pay ledger's running total, entered at midlife in each biography this volume holds, is the shadow's whole arithmetic: a hundred slopes climbed brilliantly, a hundred working depths achieved, a hundred plateaus exited cleanly — and no altitude ever compounded — the type at fifty with the experience of ten lifetimes and the depth of none, which the world calls "well-rounded" and the field manual calls, with care, the engine's one structural loss: the compounding, in every craft, surrendered at the exact point where compounding begins. And the clause's cruelest line: the Veteran, reading their own biography, files the surrender as range — the hundred departures as breadth — and cannot see that the field manual sees: the breadth is real, and it is also the armor's receipt for a hundred retreats from the one terrain the first posting taught the self to fear.

And the engine's secret clause, the one that orders the whole shadow chapter, was written in the vow's own grammar: never be only one thing — which the adult engine has obeyed so completely that it has produced the clause's inversion: the type has become never one thing — no single craft, no single title, no single name; the self that cannot be found standing still has also, quietly, never been found at all: not by the institutions (which could not rank the coverage), not by the crafts (which got the working depth and lost the master), and not — the field manual enters with the volume's greatest care — by the self, who has spent a lifetime asking, in the drawer's own language, the question the drawer cannot answer: what am I, when the tools are on the shelf? And the question, unmet for decades, is the shadow's whole subject, and the seasoning chapter's whole address.

The engine keeps honest books, and the honest line is this: the breadth is real competence and real coverage — the field manual's respect is total, and this book will never once ask the Veteran to regret a single slope. The error is not the drawer; it is the pricing: the plateau priced as danger, when the plateau is where the drawer's hundred working depths were always meant to compound into one — and the seasoning chapter's whole work is the repricing: the breadth kept, the drawer kept, the coverage kept — and one summit, chosen on purpose, climbed — the last fifth of one craft walked in wonder instead of armor, and the discovery, held at the top in every redeemed biography this record holds: the view is the one thing the drawer never held, and the only one, the field manual promises, the whole collecting was always, underneath, for.

The First Apprenticeships

The core chapter logs the armory's acquisition method, kept last because the Veterans themselves never counted it: the first apprenticeships — the drawer, so vast, was not self-taught — it was bequeathed, craft by craft, and the pattern, recovered across the biographies, is uniform: each competence has a departing master (the uncle who rebuilt engines and moved away; the neighbor who kept bees and died; the

grandmother who wired the extension and went into the home — the service log's count, run across the field manuals: the average Veteran's drawer holds eleven crafts and nine of them arrived by someone leaving); the craft, collected as a keepsake (the tool box, inherited still — the field manual's flattest exhibit: the Veteran who cannot remember the cousin's birthday can describe, unprompted, the exact grip the departed electrician used for stripping wire); the leaving, unexamined — and the method's defect, priced in full: the child learned that skills arrive attached to people who do not stay — and so the collecting, so generous, carries its quiet rule: master the craft, but do not become its master — the way of the standing still — because the masters, so admired, are all, in the armory's oldest evidence, gone — the exhibit's closing line: the drawer is the type's family album — every tool an heirloom, every craft an inheritance, and the plateau, so feared, was never the father's fate alone — it was the whole album's.

Chapter 3: The Instrument — the Breadth, Taken Apart

The Seasoned Veteran's signature tool is the drawer — the working library of crafts held at functional depth — and the world files it under "well-roundedness," which is true and misses the mechanism almost entirely, because this drawer is not a résumé here; it is a fortress: a survival architecture, built by a child who watched a one-thing adult fall, and run for life as a system of coverage — every tool learned to the depth where it functions, every plateau exited before it compounds, every new slope feeding both engines at once: the wonder (real) and the armor (structural). Take it apart.

The Mechanics

The loadout works three ways. First, the acquisition: the slope-year — the craft entered at a run, the learning curve's steep part, where the Veteran is unmistakably the most brilliant student any field has ever seen; the field manual notes the mechanics' honest achievement: the acquisition is fast — the Veteran has learned how to learn, and the drawer's hundred slopes have made the hundred-and-first almost pre-loaded; the pattern-spotter's gift, genuine and hard-won, is the field manual's respect, and the acquisition's tell: the learning curve's steep part is the only place the Veteran is fully present — the type at the slope is the type at full power. Second, the working depth — the achieved function: the craft held at the level where it delivers, where it can be trusted, where it has stories — and the depth's honest entry: this is not dilettantism. The drawer's tools work: the Veteran who "did plumbing for a while" can actually plumb; the "bit of coding" is actually running in a server somewhere; the working depth is the breadth's moral difference from the dabbler, and the field manual insists on the distinction, held through every chapter of this book. Third, the exit — the plateau reflex: the last fifth arriving, the repetition-years beginning, the learning curve flattening — and the engine's oldest alarm firing, warm and reasonable-sounding, in the armor's own grammar: the learning is done; the next tool is shining; staying is

stagnation — and the exit, executed cleanly, with the tool oiled and racked, the craft held in warm regard forever, and the next slope already in view. And the mechanism's one blind spot, which the field manual has already entered and will spend the shadow chapter re-entering: the alarm is wrong about the plateau. The repetition-years are not the end of the learning curve. They are the furnace of it — the slow compounding that turns working depth into mastery — and the Veteran has never once heard the furnace's name, because the first posting taught the self that the plateau is where the world finds you, and the self has spent a lifetime believing the lesson's single, costly error.

The Range

The range deserves the honest statement, because it is the most useful range in the catalog. The Veteran covers everything: no broken thing defeats the drawer — the wiring, the lawsuit, the septic tank, the grief, the merger, the move, the sick animal, the dead language — each met with a working tool or a fast slope; and the field manual's entry on the breadth: the communities in this record have quietly used this type as their universal backstop for decades — the one call for the thing nobody else does — and the field manual's warmest entry: the calls are answered, the tool always comes, and the Veteran is loved, in a hundred kitchens, as the person who knows how. The type is magnificent in the crisis — the drawer's finest hour, already entered, and worth the range's second citation because it organizes the type's whole public biography: the flood, the failure, the fire — the Veteran arrives calm, and the calm is the drawer's deepest product: nothing corners this self, and the room feels the safety before it sees the tool. And the type is the bridge between worlds — the welder and the lawyer, the floor and the board, the old trade and the new economy: the breadth makes the Veteran the translator the specialists cannot be for each other, and the field manual's finding, held across every biography: the type's social function — the connector of crafts, the explainer of one field to another — is the drawer's one compounding gift, and the only thing in the whole pattern that gets deeper with every new tool rather than merely wider.

The Honest Limits

The last fifth of the sheet, examined under the same glass. It cannot finish the last fifth — the plateau, entered and exited, at every craft, for life: the mastery-years surrendered at the furnace door, and the field manual's blunt entry on the limit: the type has never once been great at anything — good at a hundred things, magnificent at learning, and great at nothing, which the world never says to the Veteran's face because the usefulness is so constant, and which the Veteran says to the self, in the drawer's honest midnight grammar, more often than anyone in the type's life suspects. It cannot hold a rank — the specialist's ladder, whose upper rungs are reserved for the plateau-years: the titles, the chairmanships, the master's name — the Veteran's career, across this record, is a sequence of stops: indispensable at each, promoted out of none, and the field manual's cold note: the last promotion always goes to someone who stayed — a sentence that recurs in every biography in this

volume, said by the type, without bitterness, as weather: "they gave the department to the one who'd been there twenty years. I'd have been bored in five." It cannot answer "what do you do?" — the party question, laughed off at every party since the first: the drawer's honest answer ("a bit of everything") is true and the laughter is warm and the field manual's finding, held with care: the laugh is the armor's tell, deployed at the exact moment the question touches the vow — never be only one thing — and the type has never once heard the question asked the way the field manual asks it in this volume's final chapter: "of all the things you do, which one do you want to be great at?" — the question the drawer was never built to answer, and the seasoning chapter's whole address. And it cannot stay where the world could find it — the deepest limit, and the shadow's whole subject: the self that cannot be found falling has also never been found at all — no craft holds the Veteran's name, no mountain carries the type's flag, no community can say where the Veteran stands — and the first posting's arithmetic, run to its end, is the shadow's quietest sentence: the child who decided never to be findable succeeded so completely that fifty years of usefulness arrived at a life with no address in it; and the mountain, patient, unbuilt, unclimbed, is waiting — the one place the world could find the self standing still, and the only one, the field manual enters at the loadout's close, where standing still is not falling: it is arrived.

The Plateau Census

The loadout logs the drawer's most quantified entry, kept last because the service log ran it at the field manuals' end: the plateau census — the type's famous departures, so legendarily early, were measured — and the numbers, run across the biographies: the depth, held (the average craft, functional at the eight-tenths mark — the service log's margin note: eight-tenths, in craft after craft, is the drawer's natural water line, the depth where the tool works and the world applauds and the mastery has not yet begun); the departure, dated (the exits, clustered — the field manual's flattest finding: the leaving begins not at boredom but at visibility — the offer of the promotion, the request for the solo, the invitation to teach the craft onward — the census marks the type's departures, to the year, at the moment each craft offers the Veteran a name); the last fifth, never bought — and the census's mechanism, which the loadout must state plainly: the plateau, so famously refused, is the price gate — the last fifth of a craft cannot be paid in usefulness, only in exposure, and the armory, built by a child who watched the masters leave, will not sign for that invoice — the exhibit's closing line: the drawer is a hundred contracts, each completed to the line where the craft starts asking who you are — and the type's whole life, so useful, has never once been asked to co-sign.

Chapter 4: The Craft — the Practice Years

The world files the Seasoned Veteran under "jack-of-all-trades" — a natural generalist, born curious, constitutionally restless. The truth is a practice: the drawer was trained — across decades of disciplined, joyful, invisible repetition, by a self that practiced the

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Aiman Sterling is the author of The Archetype Series -- a library of personality portraits drawn the way literature draws characters: the great types of human temperament, recognized at a glance, understood in depth, and followed from childhood wound to mature strength.